

the pregnancy hormone estrogen. These changes prepare the vagina for childbirth. As a side effect, the extra cells mean that there is an increase in vaginal discharge, known as leukorrhea.

If you feel sore or itchy in the vaginal area and the discharge is anything other than cream or white, or smells, your doctor will need to take a swab to rule out infection.

Some infections, such as yeast, cause an abnormal discharge. They are common in pregnancy and are easily treated. Even if you've self-treated yeast infections before, call your doctor for advice this time. She'll likely recommend medication that's applied vaginally, but if she determines that you have bacterial vaginosis, oral medication may be required.